Space Force Doctrine Document -1

The Space Force

3 April 2025

Executive Summary

Space Force Doctrine Document -1 (SFDD-1), *The Space Force*, is the capstone level doctrine publication for the United States Space Force. SFDD-1 codifies why we exist as a Service, who we are as Guardians, and how we employ spacepower to drive the success of the joint force.

Why We Fight: The Imperative for Spacepower

- Securing our national interests in space requires safeguarding and enhancing the ability of US commercial, civil, intelligence, and military entities to safely access, maneuver within, and exploit the space domain without prohibitive interference. Military spacepower supports and reinforces deterrence by demonstrating America's ability and willingness to impose costs and deny an adversary's benefit from hostile actions.
- We perform our mission to "secure our Nations interests in, from , and to space" across the competition continuum, enabling joint force activities; assuring our allies and partners; and deterring, compelling, and applying force to our adversaries.
- We must be prepared to deter or compel adversary behavior and undermine adversary intent through force or the threat of force in, from, and to the space domain, and enable joint all-domain application of force.
- Competitive Endurance, is our approach to achieving space superiority, when necessary, in crisis or conflict, while maintaining the safety, security, stability, and long-term sustainability of space.

Who We Are: Guardians and Military Space Professionals

- Space Force Guardians are our greatest assets - these space-minded warfighters have internalized the Service's mission and abide by the core values of our Service – commitment, courage, connection, and character.
- We define roles and responsibilities for our officers, enlisted, and civilian members - providing a clear professional development path to build a combat-credible force. The Space Force enables its military force to leverage full- and part-time service options – creating force management flexibility, improving readiness, improving quality of life and retention, and attracting and retaining talent.
- We use a streamlined organizational structure supporting and employing a globally dispersed force.
- The Space Force includes two types of forces: institutional and operational. Operational forces may be employed-in-place (EiP), deployed, or Service retained.
- Relationships with the Air Force, joint force, sister Services, other US government agencies, allies, partners, commercial providers, and academia are all essential to the success of the Space Force.

What We Do: Employment of Spacepower

- The space domain is the area above the altitude where atmospheric effects on airborne objects become negligible. Within the space domain, we currently consider three orbital regimes (geocentric, cislunar, heliocentric) for current and future space operations. Space operations support and are supported by operations in the electromagnetic environment, cyberspace, and the air, land, and maritime domains.

- The Space Force core functions of space control, global mission operations, and space access, are the broad and enduring operational roles that we organize, train, and equip Guardians to perform. Four cross-cutting enterprise functions (intelligence, cyberspace operations, C2, and space domain awareness) are key enablers of the core functions.
- Space systems architectures include components in three segments (orbital, terrestrial, link) operating across all operational environments and domains.
- Effective C2 is essential to the application of spacepower. It includes three basic functions: gaining and maintaining situational awareness; enabling operational decision making; and directing forces. The eight C2 guiding principles (commander driven, command at echelon, mission command, shared understanding, process focused, integration and synchronization, decentralized execution, and coordinating) should inform the development and employment of C2 approaches for space forces.
- Mission command is the leadership philosophy empowering Guardians to exercise sound judgment in how they conduct their assigned tasks by emphasizing mutual trust between commanders and subordinates, disciplined initiative, and innovation.
- Battle management for space operations includes direction, coordination, integration, and deconfliction of fires, maneuvers, information, links, and sensors during operational execution.

How we Integrate into the Joint Force: Presenting Ready Forces

- As a Service Force Provider, we prepare and present forces to the combatant commanders for the purposes of fulfilling strategic, operational, and tactical objectives through the application of spacepower. A Commander of Space Force Forces (COMSPACEFOR) leads each of the Service components presented by the Space Force to combatant commands. If designated as the Combined/Joint Force Space Component Commander, the COMSPACEFOR also executes tactical control and coordination over the attached space forces of other military Services, and coalition space forces. A Space Force component field command (C-FLDCOM) is the organizational structure through which a COMSPACEFOR, or Space Force commander, conducts Service component responsibilities.
- A Space Mission Task Force (SMTF) is a warfighting structure comprised of Space Force combat formations tasked to execute a named operation of a combatant command. Every SMTF is an aggregation of elements including a commander, an element that performs C2 on behalf of the commander, and combat formations that conduct military space operations. Combat formations under an SMTF include combat deltas, combat squadrons, combat detachments, and force elements. Force elements include an operations crew, a mission-planning cell, and a mission support element.
- Maintaining readiness to secure our Nation's interests in, from, and to space, while supporting military operations in all other domains is a Space Force responsibility. Space Force Generation (SPAFORGEN) is the Space Force's model to manage the battle rhythm of rotational forces, ensuring these forces can maintain the highest possible level of overall readiness.

Access the full publication, SFDD-1, *The Space Force*, on the Space Wiki Space, the STARCOM Digital Library, the Space Force Portal, and the Guardian One App.